

KUN LEE

Address	220-554, 1 Gwanak-ro, Gwanak-gu, Seoul 08826, Republic of Korea
Email	shakgun@snu.ac.kr ; lee@lisdatacenter.org
Website	https://kunlee0910.github.io/ ; ORCID 0000-0001-9593-9317

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor of Social Welfare Policy, Department of Social Welfare, Seoul National University, Republic of Korea	2026-Present
Affiliated Scholar, Luxembourg Income Study (LIS), Luxembourg	2026-Present
Tony Atkinson Fellow, LIS Cross-National Data Center; Research Associate, Luxembourg Institute of Socio-Economic Research (LISER), Luxembourg	2024-2026
Research Affiliate, Department of Social Policy and Intervention (DSPI), University of Oxford, UK	2025-2026
Visiting Researcher, Institute for Social Development and Policy Research, Seoul National University, Republic of Korea	August 2025

EDUCATION

DPhil Social Policy, University of Oxford, UK	2020-2024
<i>Supervisors:</i> Bernhard Ebbinghaus, Marek Naczyk	
<i>Examiners:</i> Michaela Kreyenfeld, Kenneth Nelson, Erzsébet Bukodi	
MSc Comparative Social Policy (<i>Distinction</i>), University of Oxford, UK	2018-2019
BA Social Welfare & Economics (<i>Summa Cum Laude</i>), Seoul National University, Republic of Korea	2012-2018

Visiting Research & Exchange

Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, USA (4 months, Host: Fabian Pfeffer)	2024
Finnish Centre for Pensions, Helsinki, Finland (1 month, Host: Kati Kuitto)	2023
Humboldt University of Berlin, Germany (3 months, Host: Anette Fasang)	2023
University of Mannheim, Germany (4 months, Host: Bernhard Ebbinghaus)	2022
University College London, UK (Arts & Sciences, Undergraduate Exchange)	2016-2017

PUBLICATIONS*Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles* (* Corresponding author)

- Lee, K.,** Frost, D. & Ebbinghaus, B. (2026). ‘Beyond Beveridge and Bismarck: Revising the typology of pension systems for the 21st century’, *Social Policy & Administration*
- Lee, K.** (2026). ‘Old and new welfare states retaining older workers in the face of crisis: The case of COVID-19 in Europe’, *Socio-Economic Review*, 24(3): 1395–1415.
- Lee, K.** & Ebbinghaus, B. (2026). ‘Converging or unequal retirement patterns? Late working lives, retirement trajectories, and pension income in Germany over three decades of cohorts’,

Social Forces, 105(1): 54-76.

Oh, J., Son, S. & **Lee, K.*** (2025). 'Exclusion from a 'mandatory' pension scheme: Late-stage dropouts from the National Pension System in South Korea', *Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, 100578.

Kim, K. & **Lee, K.** (2025). 'Intra-couple allocation of paid and unpaid work, allocation perceptions, and life satisfaction in South Korea: An analysis based on the 'equitable specialization' framework', *Korean Journal of Social Welfare*, 77(2): 213-237 [in Korean]

Lee, K. (2024). 'Varying Effects of Public Pensions: Pension Spending and Old-age Employment under Different Pension Regimes.' *Journal of European Social Policy*, 34(1).

- JESP/ESPAnet Doctoral Researcher Prize 2023 (Best Paper)

- SASE 2023 Early Career Workshop Award

Lee, K. (2022). 'Old-age Poverty in a Pension Latecomer: The Impact of Basic Pension Expansions in South Korea', *Social Policy & Administration*, 56(7): 1022-1040.

Lee, K. & Zaidi, A. (2020). 'How policy configurations matter: a critical look into pro-natal policy in South Korea based on a gender and family framework', *International Journal of Sociology & Social Policy*, 40(7/8): 589-606.

Book Chapters

Kuitto, K. & **Lee, K.** (2025). 'How to make extending working lives in ageing welfare states socially sustainable', in M. Vaalavuo, K. Nelson & K. Kuitto (eds.), *Social Sustainability in Ageing Welfare States*, Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

Ebbinghaus, B. & **Lee, K.** (2023). 'From early retirement to later exit from work: shifting towards active ageing', in D. Clegg & N. Durazzi (eds.), *Handbook of Labour Market Policy in Advanced Democracies*, Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

AWARDS, GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Social Policy Association Travel Grant [GBP 425]	2025
KFAS-Salzburg Global Fellowship	2024
SustAgeable Consortium Grant, Helsinki, Finland [EUR 1,500]	2023
Horowitz Foundation for Social Policy Doctoral Dissertation Grant [USD 7,500]	2023
JESP/ESPAnet Doctoral Researcher Prize (Best Paper)	2023
SASE Early Career Workshop Award [USD 2,000]	2023
German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) Short-term Grant [EUR 3,850]	2022
ICPSR Summer Program Scholarship for Public Administration, Public Policy, and Public Affairs, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI, USA [USD 2,600]	2022
Centenary Scholarship, DSPI, University of Oxford, UK [GBP 85,000]	2020
Korea Foundation for Advanced Studies (KFAS) Doctoral Fellowship [USD 100,000]	2020
Republic of Korea Government Scholarship for Study Overseas [GBP 26,700]	2018

TEACHING

Seoul National University, Seoul, Republic of Korea

Welfare State Theories (Undergraduate) – *Main Instructor* Fall 2026

University of Oxford, Oxford, UK

Social Policy (Undergraduate) – *Seminar Leader* Fall 2023; 2021-2022

Quantitative Analysis (Postgraduate) – *Teaching Assistant* Fall 2023

Training for Advanced Teaching & Learning, Higher Education Academy (UK Professional Standards Framework) Winter/Spring 2022

University of Mannheim, Mannheim, Germany

Reform Dynamics in European Welfare States (Undergraduate) Spring 2023
– *Co-Instructor* (with Bernhard Ebbinghaus)

INVITED LECTURES

‘(Macro-)Panel Data Analysis using LIS data’, *LIS Summer Workshop*, Luxembourg, July 2026

‘Analyzing Panel Data in Comparative Research’, Guest lectures

- *Governance and Global Affairs Methods Lab*, Leiden University the Hague, Netherlands, 19 February 2026
- *Comparative Research Methods*, University of Mannheim, Germany, November 2022

‘Panel Data Analysis using LIS data’, *LIS Summer Workshop*, Luxembourg, July 2025

‘The Luxembourg Income and Wealth Study: Introduction and Applications to Comparative Inequality Research’, Special Lecture at the Annual Symposium of the *Korean Inequality Research Network*, Seoul, Korea, 16 July 2025

‘Introduction to the South Korean Pension System: History, Current State and Challenges’, *ETK Research Seminar*, Finnish Centre for Pensions, Helsinki, 4 October 2023

SEMINARS/WORKSHOPS

‘The politics of an unpopular pension reform: Evidence from two survey experiments in South Korea’, *Policy & Politics Workshop*, Leiden University, Netherlands, 26 March 2026

‘Still Beveridge or Bismarck? Revising the typology of pension systems for the 21st Century’, *European Symposium on Policy Modelling*, Luxembourg, 25 March 2026

‘Welfare states and wealth inequality: Pension systems, the public-private mix, and augmented wealth in old age’

- *ETK Pension Research Forum*, Finnish Centre for Pensions, 16 March 2026
- *(LIS)²ER-SHARE Workshop: Pensions and Old-age Well-being*, 27-28 November 2025
- *CBS Seminar*, Herman Deleeck Centre for Social Policy, University of Antwerp, 15 May 2025

‘Threats of AI? How workers perceive and respond to technological change in the workplace’

- *East Asian Political Economy Workshop*, King’s College London, 26 June 2025
- *Netspar International Pension Workshop*, Leiden, 18 June 2025

‘Convergence or continued stratification? Late working lives, retirement trajectories, and

pension income in Germany’

- *Sequence Analysis Association Webinar Series*, 17 October 2024 (online)
- *LISER Seminar Series*, Luxembourg, 7 November 2024

‘Socio-demographic differences in older workers’ job loss in the early phase of the pandemic’, *ESPAnet Germany PhD Workshop*, WZB Berlin, 16-17 March 2023

‘The Impact of Basic Pension Expansions on Older People’s Income and Poverty in South Korea’, *BSA Social Statistics Group Brown Bag* (online), 30 September 2021

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (* Poster)

Annual ESPAnet Conference (ISEG Lisbon, Portugal); World Inequality Conference 2026 (Paris School of Economics, France); PAA Annual Meeting (St. Louis, MO, USA); In_equality Conference (University of Konstanz, Germany); Winter School on Inequality and Social Welfare Theory (University of Verona, Canazei, Italy)

ISI Wealth Inequality Conference (LMU Munich, Germany); READI Annual Meeting 2025 (Yonsei University, Seoul, Korea); SPA Annual Conference (University of York, UK); PAA Annual Meeting (Washington DC, USA); ISA-RC28 Spring Meeting (University of Milan, Italy); Comparative Economic Inequality Conference (Luxembourg)

Annual ESPAnet Conference (Tampere University, Finland); EASP-FISS Joint 2024 Conference (Kyoto, Japan); PAA Annual Meeting* (Columbus, OH, USA)

Annual ESPAnet Conference (University of Warsaw, Poland); ISA-RC28 Summer 2023 Meeting* (University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, USA); SASE Annual Conference (Rio de Janeiro, Brazil); SPA Annual Conference (University of Nottingham, UK); ISA-RC28 Spring Meeting (Sciences Po, Paris, France)

ESA-RN26 Mid-term Conference (Berlin, Germany); Annual ESPAnet Conference 2022 (University of Vienna, Austria); FISS Annual Conference (Sigtuna, Sweden)

Annual ESPAnet Conference (online); BSA Work, Employment & Society Meeting 2021 (online); EASP-FISS Joint Annual Conference (online)

East Asian Social Policy Annual Conference (National Taiwan University, Taipei) 2019

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Journal Referee: Ageing & Society; Applied Economics; Applied Economics Letters; Asian Social Work & Policy Review; Economic Modeling; International Journal of Social Welfare; International Journal of Sociology & Social Policy; Humanities & Social Science Communications; Journal of Ageing & Social Policy; Journal of Asian Public Policy; Journal of Economic Inequality; Journal of the Economics of Ageing; Journal of Governmental Studies; Journal of Population Ageing; Journal of Public Policy; Nature Scientific Data; Poverty & Public Policy; Review of the Economics of Household; Social Policy & Administration; Social Science Research; Socius; Work, Aging and Retirement

Core Member, Pensions Policy Research Group, Social Policy Association UK, 2023-Present

Main Organizer, (LIS)²ER Visiting Program & Seminar Series, 2024-2026

Organizing Committee, (LIS)²ER-SHARE Luxembourg Joint Workshop: “Pensions and Old-age Well-being: Policy Challenges in Ageing Societies”, 27-28 November 2025

Organizing Committee, 5th (LIS)²ER Workshop: “Fighting Poverty: Measurement and Policy Challenges”, 11-13 December 2024

Organizing Committee, Symposium for Early Researchers in Social Policy & Intervention, Nuffield College, Oxford, 27 May 2022

Co-chair, Young Scholar Session: Labour market and social policy responses to the pandemic, The COVID-19 Public Health and Social Measures (PHSMs) Conference, 6 October 2021

ENGAGEMENT ACTIVITIES

‘A Slow Convergence? Intra-couple Division of Labour and Related Perceptions in South Korea, 2004–2024’, *LIS Newsletter*, Issue No. 38, June 2026

‘How pension systems (re)shape the landscape of wealth inequality and redistribution’, *LIS Newsletter*, Issue No. 37, March 2026

2nd KFAS-Salzburg Global Leadership Initiative: Technology, Growth & Inequality, 2024-25

Contributions to Oxford Supertracker: A global database for COVID-19 policy trackers

Organizing Committee, Oxford-Korea Forum, Wolfson College, Oxford, 12 November 2021

‘Myths and Truths of the South Korean National Pension’, *Oxford Korean Academic Society* Public Lecture Series, 1 December 2023

‘Changes in European Countries’, in Sang-jin Han (ed.), *An International Comparative Study on Citizen Participatory Governance Model and Health and Welfare Policies in the COVID-19 Era*, Policy Report for the Ministry of Health and Welfare, Republic of Korea

‘Europe’s Policy Responses to the Labour Market Crisis during the Pandemic’, *Oxford Korean Academic Society* Public Lecture Series, 21 October 2021

Treasurer, Oxford Korean Academic Society, University of Oxford, 2020-21

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, University of Oxford, UK	2021
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Research Assistant, Seoul National University, Korea	2021
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Research Assistant, King’s College London, UK	2020
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Administrative Assistant, Seoul National University, Korea	2019-2020
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IARU Global Intern, Oxford Institute of Population Ageing, Oxford, UK	2019
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Social Work Trainee, Hanwoori Rehabilitation Center, Seoul, Korea	2018
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Military Service, National Assembly Police Officer, Seoul, Korea	2014-2015
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OTHER SKILLS

Languages: English (fluent), Korean (native)

Statistical Software: R, Stata

